COMMON BUSINESS EMAIL FORMAT/CONTENT

From	Your name/email address – your software application will usually auto-generate this content.
To	This is where you target the **primary audience** by entering their **email address.**
CC	**CC** or **Carbon Copy** is where you target and **secondary audiences** (people who might not need to act directly on the ideas of your email, but might find it helpful to know).
BCC	**BCC** or **Blind Carbon Copy** is where a **third audience** is targeted, but identities are not visible to other audiences. This is a secretive way of sharing information. Be careful - it can be considered a bad practice to BCC a third audience since good communication should be honest, open and transparent.
Subject	The subject line of an email is used to indicate **the topic of the message** in a manner that allows the audience to know 'at a glance' what they should expect the message to be about, even before reading the message. The subject line is incredibly important, as it is **the first thing that the audience will evaluate** as they decide whether or not to open the email. The Subject line should be short, and to the point. Overly long, or confusing subject lines often result in messages going unread, or being filtered into spam folders by mail applications.
Date/Time	The actual date/time that the message was sent/received – your software application will usually auto-generate this content.
Attachments	Instead of including lots of detailed content in the body of an email, **document and image files** can be sent within emails. When adding a file as an attached file, the filename will be shown here. • Be careful with file-names: use meaningful filenames that indicate what type of date the file contains. Attaching **document1.docx** and **document2.docx** is unhelpful to the target audience. • Also be careful to not attach documents that are too large in file-size, as some service providers have size limitations that might cause messages to be undeliverable. • If attaching a document, be sure to include a statement in the email body to introduce the attached file and your reason for including it.

Salutation	It is important to open an email with a greeting and the name(s) of the intended primary reader.
Opening	In the opening, write a sentence to **introduce the subject** of the message and include an important statement that clearly indicates the purpose or function of the message. If responding to a message, make reference to the previous contact. If writing about a specific indent, identify it and explain what is important about it.
Main Message	The Main Message is where you deliver the most important aspect of the message. • Include specific reference to WHO, WHAT, WHERE, WHEN, WHY, and HOW, and the connection to the main focus of the message. • If an attachment is included, make reference to it and explain the reason for including it. • If specific follow-up action is necessary, clearly state expectations of Who, What, and When.
Closing	Bring the message to a **positive** conclusion, and possibly refer to future communications.
Valediction and Signature	Sign off with a 'complimentary closing' phrase, along with your name and additional contact details.

Note:
It is important to use separate paragraphs for each of the sections of an email so that the reader immediately recognizes the format and purpose of each part of the message. If the message is not clearly separated into sections, it will be likely to be considered as 'low readability', and might negatively impact how easy the message is to read and understand.